ENOCH NTSIFUL

PhD Candidate in Economics ◇ University of Barcelona (Spain)

E-mail ◇ Website ◇ IEB profile ◇ Google Scholar ◇ ORCiD ◇ LinkedIn ◇ Bluesky

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Development economics; Environmental economics; Energy economics
Secondary: Health economics; International trade; Labour economics; Gender economics; Application of Machine Learning tools in economic analyses

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics, University of Barcelona, Spain 2023 – June 2027 (expected)
Thesis: Economics of sustainable cooling/heating solutions
Supervisors: François Cohen & Jordi J. Teixidó Figueras

MSc Quantitative Economics (QED), University of Alicante, Spain 2022 – 2024
Specialisation: Labour Economics, Experimental Economics

MPhil in Economics, Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST) 2021 – 2022
Joint CMAP Economics, African Economic Research Consortium (AERC).
Specialisation: Econometrics, Environmental Economics

BA Economics, KNUST, Kumasi, Ghana 2015 – 2019

JOB MARKET PAPER

Refrigeration, Food Security, and Nutrition: Evidence from Ghana (with François Cohen)
Food insecurity in low-income countries is typically analysed through agricultural production and purchasing power, with little attention paid to downstream food distribution. We study the welfare consequences of disruptions in final-stage food storage. Our identification exploits appliance breakdowns in Ghana, comparing households with functioning and broken refrigerators purchased at the same time and at similar prices. Breakdowns increase perceived food insecurity by one-third and reduce consumption of animal-sourced foods, lowering intake of vitamin B12. These findings highlight household refrigeration as an underappreciated lever to improve diets and reduce widespread micronutrient deficiencies as electrification rapidly expands.
Awards: IREA Best Working Paper Award (Jan 2026); Best Paper Award, UB PhD in Economics Workshop (Dec 2025).
Earlier version: IREA Working Paper IR25/23, "Refrigeration, Diets and Human Health: Evidence from Ghana".

WORKING PAPERS

- Large-Scale Evidence on the Benefits from Off-Grid Technologies (with François Cohen & Jordi J. Teixidó)
- Bridging the divide: Housing infrastructure and energy poverty (with Bright Tetteh)
- Power Outages, Sales, and Employment in Informal Sector Firms: Evidence from 12 Developing Countries (with Bright Tetteh)
- Robust Determinants of Multidimensional Energy Poverty (with Pamela Efua Ofori & Isaac K. Ofori)

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Effect of electricity access on the value of women's labour and time in Ghana**
  World Development Perspectives (Q1) · DOI: 10.1016/j.wdp.2024.100614 · **Ntsiful, E.** et al. (2024)
- **Trade Policy Uncertainty, Trade, and Economic Growth in Africa: What Can the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) Offer?**
  The International Trade Journal (Q3) · DOI: 10.1080/08853908.2025.2538861 · Dramani, J. B. et al. (2025)

- **The welfare of Ghanaian women in trade: the role of English and French language literacy**
  Journal of Humanities and Applied Social Sciences · DOI: 10.1108/JHASS-08-2023-0091 · Yegblemenawo, S. A. M. & **Ntsiful, E.** (2024)
- **A comparative analysis of the performances of macroeconomic indicators during the Global Financial Crisis, COVID-19 Pandemic, and the Russia-Ukraine War: The Ghanaian case**
  Research in Globalization (Q1) · DOI: 10.1016/j.resglo.2023.100174 · Tetteh, B. & **Ntsiful, E.** (2023)
- **The effects of economic growth, trade liberalization, and financial development on environmental sustainability in West Africa. The role of institutions**
  Research in Globalization (Q1) · DOI: 10.1016/j.resglo.2022.100104 · Baajike, F. B. et al. (2022)

POLICY WRITING

Unlocking Climate Adaptation at COP31
Highlight, *Les Cahiers de l'Environnement*, No. 4, Special Edition: COP and Climate Change (forthcoming) · **Ntsiful, E.**, Cohen, F. & Fahr, P. (2026)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Sibling Gender, Inheritance Customs Law, and Child Education: Evidence from Patrilineal and Matrilineal Societies in Ghana (with Hardi Ahmed & Kwabena Nkansah)
- Examining the prospects of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) Agreement: Does trade with South Africa promote growth in the SADC region? (with Bright Tetteh & Josephine Asare)
- Financial institution development and renewable electricity generation in EMICs and LICs (co-authored)
- Electricity transmission and distributional losses, energy security, and economic growth in Ghana: The role of institutional quality (co-authored)

AWARDS, GRANTS & PRIZES

- Best Working Paper Award, IREA, University of Barcelona, for the JMP — Jan 2026
- Best Paper Award, UB PhD in Economics Workshop 2025, for the JMP — Dec 2025
- Formació d'Investigadors (FI) Grant, Catalan Government (UB, Spain) — May 2024 – present
- Workshop grant, III Workshop on Development Economics in Spain, CUNEF University — Oct 2025
- Workshop grant, 9th International PhD Meeting in Economics, University of Macedonia — Jul 2025
- Erasmus+ KA107 Grant (University of Alicante, Spain) — 2022 – 2024
- 2nd Best Student, MPhil Economics, KNUST, Ghana — 2021/22
- Dean's Excellence Award in Bachelor Studies, Faculty of Social Sciences, KNUST, Ghana — 2018/19

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS & WORKSHOPS

Upcoming

- SAEe 2026, Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía, Universidad de Las Palmas de Gran Canaria, Spain — Dec 2026
- 2nd BCN Development Economics, UAB, Barcelona — Nov 2026

2026

- 3rd Early Career Workshop on Applied Environmental & Climate Change Economics (AECCE), Università di Urbino Carlo Bo, Italy — Oct 2026
- Energy thematic day, Université Côte d'Azur, Nice, France — May 2026
- Scientific Conference for the Creation of Sustainable Social Scenarios, Hub en Sostenibilitat Global, UB — May 2026

- IEB PhD Students Seminar, UB — Apr 2026
- 2026 UB|IREA Annual Conference, UB — Feb 2026
- 1st BCN Development Economics Workshop, UB — Feb 2026

2025 and earlier

- III Workshop on Development Economics in Spain (SPANDE), CUNEF University, Madrid — Oct 2025
- III PhD Conference in Social Sciences and Economics, Sapienza University of Rome — Sep 2025
- 9th International PhD Meeting in Economics, University of Macedonia — Jul 2025
- Centre for Social Policy Studies, University of Ghana — Jun 2025
- BSE Jamboree 12th edition, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona — May 2025
- III PhD Research Horizons Seminar, Kozminski University — May 2025
- International Conference on Empirical Economics (ICEE), PSU Altoona, USA — 2023, 2024, 2025
- EIEE (CMCC) Webinar-Seminar: earlier JMP version, presented by coauthor F. Cohen — Nov 2025

Webinars: see the personal website for all webinars

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Industrial Organisation (course page), University of Barcelona — Autumn 2025/26 & 2026/27
Department of Econometrics, Statistics and Applied Economics

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, KNUST, Ghana — 2019 – 2020
Advanced Macroeconomics; Development Economics; Elements of Economics

Guest talk: "Practical steps toward a reproducible research" — Sep 2026
Informal talk for PhD students, Department of Economics, KNUST; based on the UBSE BESTEPS guide

School teaching: Mathematics, Integrated Science & French — 2014 – 2015
Global Doors International School & Real Topgrade International School, Ghana

REFEREE FOR JOURNALS

World Development Perspectives; Energy Research & Social Science

NON-ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

Marketing manager, Longrich International, Mankessim, Ghana — Jul – Aug 2019
Intern, Because-of-you Centre, Mankessim, Ghana — May – Aug 2016, 2017, 2018

LEADERSHIP & CHARITY ROLES

- National Secretary, Youth/PENSA Ministry (2024 – present) and District Secretary, Barcelona District (2025 – present), The Church of Pentecost Int'l, Spain
- President, Economics Christian Fellowship and Associates (ECFA), KNUST — 2018 – 2019
- Deputy Academic Board Chairman (2017 – 2018) and Judicial Committee Member (2016 – 2017), Economics Students Association, KNUST

PROGRAMMING & LANGUAGES

Programming: Stata, LaTeX, EViews, R, Matlab, Python (beginner)
Languages: English (official & proficient); Akan (native); French (basic); Spanish & Catalan (beginner)

REFEREES

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